“You know, I think I only have one question left.” Alice’s father put away his phone, drank some more of his second martini, and leaned in a bit. “Do you really believe this? Honestly? That multiple copies of me come into existence every time someone measures the spin of a particle?”

Alice sat back in her chair, savored a bit of her wine, and looked thoughtful. “You know, I really do. At least, I personally find Everettian quantum mechanics, and all the many worlds that it implies, to be by far the most plausible version of quantum theory that I know of. If that means I must accept that my present self will evolve into a number of slightly different future selves who will never be able to talk to each other, I’m willing to accept that. Subject, as always, to being updated in the future if new information comes along, either in the form of experimental results or new theoretical insights.”

“Such a good empiricist.” Her father smiled.

“Let me quote David Deutsch,” Alice offered. “He once said, ‘Despite the unrivaled empirical success of quantum theory, the very suggestion that it may be *literally true as a description of nature* is still greeted with cynicism, incomprehension, and even anger.’”

“What’s that supposed to mean? Every physicist thinks quantum mechanics describes nature.”

“I think when Deutsch says ‘quantum theory,’ he implicitly means Many-Worlds.” Now it was Alice’s turn to smile. “What he was getting at was that many people reject Everettian quantum mechanics more out of a visceral sense of distaste than a principled set of worries. But as philosopher David Lewis once put it, ‘I do not know how to refute an incredulous stare.’”

“I hope you’re not including me there.” Alice’s father looked slightly affronted. “I’ve just been trying to understand the theory in a principled way.”

“You have!” Alice replied. “The conversation we’ve just been having—whether or not I convinced you of anything at all, this is what all thoughtful physicists should be talking about. What matters to me is not that everyone become an Everettian, but that people take the challenge of understanding quantum mechanics seriously. I’d much rather have a dialogue with someone who is a dedicated proponent of hidden variables, for example, than try to engage the interest of someone who just doesn’t care.”